

array failure, critical servers can be brought online using either the primary array or directly on the secondary array. Having this capability reduces the amount of time critical services and data would be unavailable. As a further precaution, full backups are made on a removable drive each night (Monday through Friday). The removable drives can store 30 days of restorable copies. Backups are tested in a sandbox environment to ensure restorability.

Challenges and Solutions

Southwest Technical College's IT department faces a range of challenges, from maintaining an aging infrastructure to adapting to rapidly evolving technologies. Balancing security and accessibility is a constant concern, as we must protect sensitive data while ensuring seamless access for students, faculty, and staff across multiple devices and platforms. Budget constraints often limit our ability to invest in necessary upgrades or staff training, even as the demand for reliable technology grows. Additionally, the IT department must support diverse needs, such as hybrid learning environments, research computing, and campus-wide communication systems, all while addressing cybersecurity threats and meeting compliance requirements. These challenges require strategic planning, cross-department collaboration, and innovative problem-solving to meet the demands of a modern campus.

Summary

Southwest Technical College's program offerings for students are diverse, requiring a significant investment in equipment, technology, lab space, classrooms, testing centers, offices, and general gathering areas. Oversight of these areas is the primary responsibility of the Director of Facilities and Director of Information Technology. The Facilities and IT teams strive to maintain an adequate, safe, and clean environment essential for student learning.